

Accounting module user guide

Configure company and client rates, close the week, export to Xero, and send clients a timesheet they can check themselves.

Audience: Accounting / finance administrators

Module path: Finance → Accounting

Prepared for: Holly · Continental Cargo

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1. What this module does

Accounting turns real clocked hours into **pay** (wage cost) and **charge** (client billing), then produces the files you need for Xero and for the invoice you send the client.

Pay

What labour costs — staff hourly rate and pay matrix.

Charge

What you bill the client — that client's hours and charge rates.

Xero files

One sales line per client for the week. One bill line per staff member.

Client timesheet

Time in, time out, break, hours by band, overtime start, and \$ — attach this to the invoice.

Important

Always use a real workforce employee for timesheets and rate cards. Admin, master, and kiosk accounts are not staff.

2. Scope — what this is and is not

This is **not a live connection to Xero**. The system does not log in to Xero, sync invoices, or post bills automatically. You download CSV files and import them into Xero yourself (or attach the timesheet to the client invoice).

In scope

- Rate and time-band setup (company, staff, per client)
- Weekly review and close
- Xero-ready **CSV exports** (sales and bills)
- Detailed client timesheet (in / out, break, bands, OT start, \$)

Out of scope

- Xero API, bank feed, or automatic posting
- Automatic invoice email to clients
- Payroll lodging (STP, super, PAYG)

3. Where everything lives

Tab	Use
Overview	Week health, totals, setup warnings.
Settings → Pay & charge rules	Company bands, day types, overtime, minimums, holidays, employment types, Xero.
Settings → Rate cards → Staff	Employment type, hourly rate, pay matrix.
Settings → Rate cards → Clients	That client's From / To hours and charge % or \$.
Settings → Rate cards → Defaults	Company fallback hourly rate and matrices.
Weekly close	Review exceptions, freeze or reopen the week.
Exports	Xero, client timesheet, band summary, journal, charge pack.

4. Configure this first

Do these steps before expecting non-zero dollars or working exports.

1 Confirm your access role

Accounting module plus *Edit staff and site rate cards*, *Edit pay rules, bands, and holidays*, and *Export accounting reports (CSV)*. Without Export you will see “No export permission”.

2 Set client states (Xero Location tracking)

Settings → Clients — set **State** to NSW, QLD, VIC, etc. This matches your Xero category *Location*.

3 Company rules

Accounting → Settings → Pay & charge rules

Week start, rounding, minimum hours, time bands, day types, overtime (daily and weekly), public holidays, employment types / GL codes, Xero settings.

4 Company defaults

Accounting → Settings → Rate cards → Defaults

Default hourly rate and pay / charge matrices (% or \$).

5 Staff rates

Accounting → Settings → Rate cards → Staff

Select a real employee and set a **base hourly rate greater than \$0**. Percentage cells multiply against this rate.

6 Client hours and rates

Accounting → Settings → Rate cards → Clients

Edit that client's From / To and charge % or \$. See section 5.

If everything is \$0

Almost always the staff hourly rate is still 0 while matrices are %, or hours were logged on an admin account. Fix the rate card, then re-check Overview.

5. Client hours and rates (per customer)

Every number used to charge a client can be set on that client. Two customers can have different early-morning windows and loadings:

- Client A — Early morning **00:00–06:00 @ 125%**
- Client B — Early morning **00:00–06:30 @ 120%**

Path: Accounting → Settings → Rate cards → Clients

1 Select the client.

2 **Client time bands** already shows the company hours (Name, From, To). You do not need to add a band first.

3 Change **From** / **To** for this client (for example Early morning to 06:30). Overnight wrap is allowed (22:00–06:00).

4 Under **Client charge rates**, choose **Edit** on the cells you want to customise (% or \$). Leave a cell on **Default** to use company rules.

5 Click **Save client rates**.

These hours and rates are for this client only

Reset to company bands

returns this client to company hours.

Add client band

adds an extra window; it appears as a new row in the charge matrix so you can set its % or \$.

If you never edit the hours, the client inherits the company bands. As soon as you change a field, those hours are stored for that client. The charge matrix uses the same bands — the row label shows the hours, for example *Early morning (00:00–06:30)*.

6. Staff rates

Path: Accounting → Settings → Rate cards → Staff

- Employment type — Full Time, Part Time, Casual, Contractor
- **Base hourly rate (\$)** — required when matrices are in %
- Optional min pay hours / effective from
- Pay matrix — Default inherits company; Edit sets a custom \$ or %

Company overtime applies to everyone: daily (default more than 8 hours) and weekly (default more than 38 hours). Both can apply in the same week.

7. Weekly close — what it does

Close week freezes the pay and charge figures for that week. It does **not** send anything to Xero, stop staff from clocking in, or lock Attendance.

If you leave the week open

Accounting keeps recalculating. Overview and Exports always show the **current** hours and rates. You can still export. If someone later adds a missed punch or edits a time, **the totals change**. If you already imported a CSV into Xero, the next export may no longer match.

If you close the week

The system saves a snapshot (who closed, when, and the totals). Overview, Weekly close, and Exports for **that week** use that snapshot. New clocks, attendance edits, or rate changes **do not change those numbers** until you click **Reopen week**.

If you close, then new records come in, and you do not reopen

The new punches **are saved** in Attendance. Nobody loses a clock. They simply **do not appear** in Accounting totals or in the CSVs until you reopen.

Example

You close Monday at \$4,000. Tuesday someone enters 4 forgotten hours. Attendance has those hours. Accounting still shows \$4,000. After

Reopen week

, the live total includes the 4 hours. If you already imported the old CSV into Xero, export again (or adjust Xero by hand).

Recommended

Review exceptions →

Close week

when the figure is the one you will invoice or import → then download Xero and the client timesheet.

Reopen only if you need to correct hours.

Weeks closed before September 2026 may not show time in / out on the timesheet until reopened.

8. Weekly flow

- 1 Record hours for a real employee (kiosk, employee app, or [Attendance](#) → [Add manual record](#)). Do not clock the accounting admin user.
- 2 Open [Accounting](#) → [Overview](#) . Pay / Charge should not be \$0.
- 3 Open [Accounting](#) → [Weekly close](#) , review exceptions, then **Close week** to freeze figures.
- 4 Open [Accounting](#) → [Exports](#) . Download Xero sales / bills for import, and **Client timesheet CSV** to attach to the invoice.

Reopen week returns to live calculation (needs pay-rules permission). Weeks closed before this update may not show time in / out until you reopen them.

9. Exports — which file to use

File	Who uses it	What it contains
Xero sales invoices	Xero import	One charge line per client for the week. TrackingName1 / TrackingOption1 = Location / state when tracking is on.
Xero bills	Xero import	One pay line per staff member for the week , split by site when Location tracking is on.
Client timesheet CSV	Attach to the client invoice	One row per shift: staff, date, client, day type, time in, time out, break (minutes), hours, hours and \$ by band (Base, Early morning, Afternoon, Overtime), OT starts, total \$.
Band summary CSV	Internal only	Pay/charge already split by day type and band. Not the file you send to clients.
Journal	GL / internal	Debit/credit by employment type.
Charge pack	Internal	Hours and \$ by site and band.
Summary CSV	Internal	Pay / charge / margin for the current filters.

Xero vs client invoice

Xero stays one line per week on purpose. The

Client timesheet

is the detailed proof — clock times and how each hour was classified — so the client can verify the total themselves.

10. Xero Location tracking

Aligned with Xero → Settings → Tracking categories → **Location** (NSW / QLD / VIC...).

1. **Settings** → **Clients** — set each client's **State**.
2. **Accounting** → **Settings** → **Pay & charge rules** → **Xero export settings** — keep Location tracking on and the category name exactly **Location**.
3. Export sales / bills — CSVs include *TrackingName1* and *TrackingOption1*.

11. Worked example

Staff hourly rate **\$30**. Monday **04:00–12:00** (8 hours). Weekday early morning **00:00–06:00 @ 125%**.

Segment	Hours	Pay rate	Pay \$
Early morning 04:00–06:00	2	125% = \$37.50	\$75.00
Base 06:00–12:00	6	100% = \$30.00	\$180.00
Total pay	8		\$255.00

Charge uses that **client's** From / To and charge matrix (which may differ from pay). If the same staff works 4 hours at JAS, the Client timesheet row should show the actual in / out, any unpaid break, which hours sit in Early morning vs Base, and the total charge.

12. Checklist before you rely on a week

- Role has Accounting + rates + rules + export
- Clients have State set (for Xero Location)
- Company bands, overtime (daily + weekly), and minimums reviewed
- Staff hourly rate > \$0
- Each client's hours (From / To) and charge % checked
- Hours logged on a real employee
- Overview shows non-zero totals
- Week closed before final Xero files
- Client invoice gets **Client timesheet CSV**, not the band summary